

Option P5: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945–95

Key topic 1: The birth of the state of Israel, 1945–63

1 The British withdrawal and the creation of Israel	• Conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate. • Key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181. • Key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).
2 Aftermath of the 1948–49 war	• Territorial changes and their impact. The refugee status of Palestinian Arabs. • The creation of the Israeli Defence Forces and the Law of Return. US aid to Israel. • Israel's relations with Egypt.
3 Increased tension, 1955–63	• Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world. • The events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and Sinai in 1956. • The events and significance of the Suez Crisis (1956), including the formation of the UAR in 1958.

Key topic 2: The escalating conflict, 1964–73

1 The Six Day War, 1967	• The significance of the Cairo Conference (1964). Escalating tension between Israel, Syria and Jordan: Syria's support for Fatah, Israel's raid on Samu and events of 7 April 1967. • The actions of the USSR, Nasser and the USA in the period leading to war. • Key events of the war.
2 Aftermath of the 1967 war	• UN Resolution 242 and continued dispute over the Suez Canal. • Palestinian refugees and the significance of the occupied territories: Golan Heights, Gaza Strip, West Bank, Sinai and East Jerusalem. • The use of terrorism, Israel's response and international attitudes towards the Palestine issue: the PFLP airplane hijacks of 1970; Black September and the Munich Olympics. The expulsion of the PLO from Jordan (1970).
3 Israel and Egypt, 1967–73	• Egyptian relations with Israel, the USA, the USSR and other Arab states. • Israel's consolidation of control of the occupied territories. • Key events of the Yom Kippur War (1973) and its aftermath.

Key topic 3: Attempts at a solution, 1974–95

1 Diplomatic negotiations	• The significance of the oil crisis and the involvement of the USA and the USSR. • Kissinger, 'shuttle diplomacy' and the reopening of the Suez Canal. • Sadat's visit to Israel (1977), Begin's visit to Egypt (1977), US President Carter and Camp David (1978) and the Treaty of Washington (1979).
2 The Palestinian issue	• Arafat's speech to the UN (1974). The significance of PLO activities in Lebanon. • Israeli reprisals, the invasion of Lebanon (1982) and the results. • The Israeli occupied territories and the First Palestinian Intifada (1987–93).
3 Attempts at a solution	• The significance of Arafat's renunciation of terrorism in a speech at the UN (1988). • Changing superpower policies in the Middle East: US involvement in the Gulf War (1991), and the end of the Cold War. • Arafat, Rabin and the Oslo Accords (1993); the setting up of the Palestinian National Authority; Israel-Jordan peace treaty (1994); Oslo II (1995).

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Overview

The relevant pages of this section specify the content that must be taught for the chosen option.

Students are required to study one modern depth study. All of the content for the option is mandatory.

The depth studies focus on a substantial and coherent short time span and require students to understand the complexity of a society or historical situation and the interplay of different aspects within it. Depending on the depth study chosen, these may include social, economic, political, cultural and military aspects.

The main content is divided into four key topics. These provide a framework for teaching and understanding the option, but should not be taken in isolation from each other. For each depth study, there is some chronological overlap between key topics – this structure helps highlight the complexity and interplay of different aspects within society.

Assessment

Students will be assessed on all four Assessment Objectives. All questions may relate to any content specified in the four key topics.

Questions focusing solely on knowledge and understanding will target causation.

Other questions will target the ability to analyse and evaluate contemporary sources and later interpretations. Students should be aware that interpretations are based on evidence from their period of study. They should be aware of a range of evidence that can be used to reach conclusions. They should study examples of such evidence and consider ways in which it could give rise to and support different interpretations. Students should understand a range of reasons why interpretations may differ. They should be aware that differences based on conclusions drawn from evidence are legitimate and can be explained. They should be able to evaluate given interpretations using their own knowledge of the period.